Interior Point Methods

CME 307 / MS&E 315 /OIT 676 Optimization

Wenzhi Gao 

ICME, Stanford University

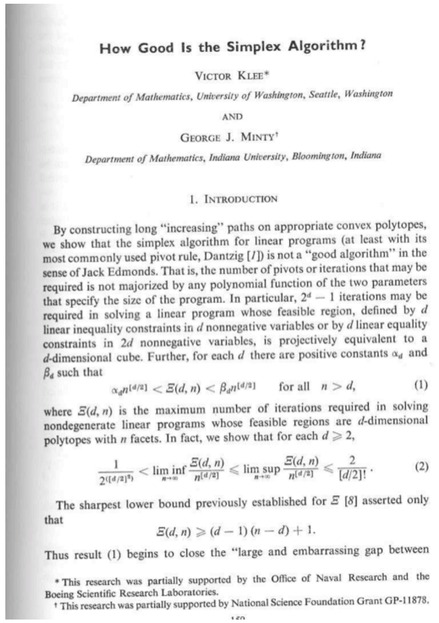
Review

- Optimality/KKT condition
- Conic linear optimization
- Newton's method

Today's goal: understand the insights behind IPM

History of linear programming

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & \langle c, x \rangle \\ \text{subject to} \quad & Ax = b \\ & x \geq 0 \end{aligned}$$



How Good Is the Simplex Algorithm?

VICTOR KLEE*
Department of Mathematics, University of Washington, Seattle, Washington
AND
GEORGE J. MINTY†
Department of Mathematics, Indiana University, Bloomington, Indiana

1. INTRODUCTION

By constructing long "increasing" paths on appropriate convex polytopes, we show that the simplex algorithm for linear programs (at least with its most commonly used pivot rule, Dantzig [1]) is not a "good algorithm" in the sense of Jack Edmonds. That is, the number of pivots or iterations that may be required is not majorized by any polynomial function of the two parameters that specify the size of the program. In particular, $2^d - 1$ iterations may be required in solving a linear program whose feasible region, defined by d linear inequality constraints in d nonnegative variables or by d linear equality constraints in $2d$ nonnegative variables, is projectively equivalent to a d-dimensional cube. Further, for each d there are positive constants α_d and β_d such that

$$\alpha_d n^{\lfloor d/2 \rfloor} < \Xi(d, n) < \beta_d n^{\lfloor d/2 \rfloor} \quad \text{for all} \quad n > d, \tag{1}$$

where $\Xi(d, n)$ is the maximum number of iterations required in solving nondegenerate linear programs whose feasible regions are d-dimensional polytopes with n facets. In fact, we show that for each $d \geqslant 2$,

$$\frac{1}{2^{\lfloor d/2 \rfloor}} < \liminf_{n \to \infty} \frac{\Xi(d, n)}{n^{\lfloor d/2 \rfloor}} \leqslant \limsup_{n \to \infty} \frac{\Xi(d, n)}{n^{\lfloor d/2 \rfloor}} \leqslant \frac{2}{\lfloor d/2 \rfloor!}. \tag{2}$$

The sharpest lower bound previously established for Ξ [8] asserted only that

$$\Xi(d, n) \geqslant (d - 1)(n - d) + 1.$$

Thus result (1) begins to close the "large and embarrassing gap between

* This research was partially supported by the Office of Naval Research and the Boeing Scientific Research Laboratories.
† This research was partially supported by National Science Foundation Grant GP-11878.

- Simplex method invented by George Dantzig in 1947

  Dramatic practical performance; exponential worst-case in n in theory (1970)

- Stanford MS&E was by then the center of LP and operations research

Search for an efficient polynomial time algorithm





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A Soviet Discovery Rocks World of Mathematics

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By MALCOLM W. BROWNE

A surprise discovery by an obscure Soviet mathematician has rocked the world of mathematics and computer analysis, and experts have begun exploring its practical applications.

Mathematicians describe the discovery by L.G. Khachian as a method by which computers can find guaranteed solutions to a class of very difficult problems that have hitherto been tackled on a kind of hit-or-miss basis.

Apart from its profound theoretical interest, the discovery may be applicable in weather prediction, complicated industrial processes, petroleum refining, the scheduling of workers at large factories, secret codes and many other things.

"I have been deluged with calls from virtually every department of government for an interpretation of the significance of this," a leading expert on computer methods, Dr. George B. Dantzig of Stanford University, said in an interview.

The solution of mathematical problems by computer must be broken down into a series of steps. One class of problem sometimes involves so many steps that it could take billions of years to compute.

The Russian discovery offers a way by which the number of steps in a solution can be dramatically reduced. It also offers the mathematician a way of learning quickly whether a problem has a solution or not, without having to complete the entire immense computation that may be required.

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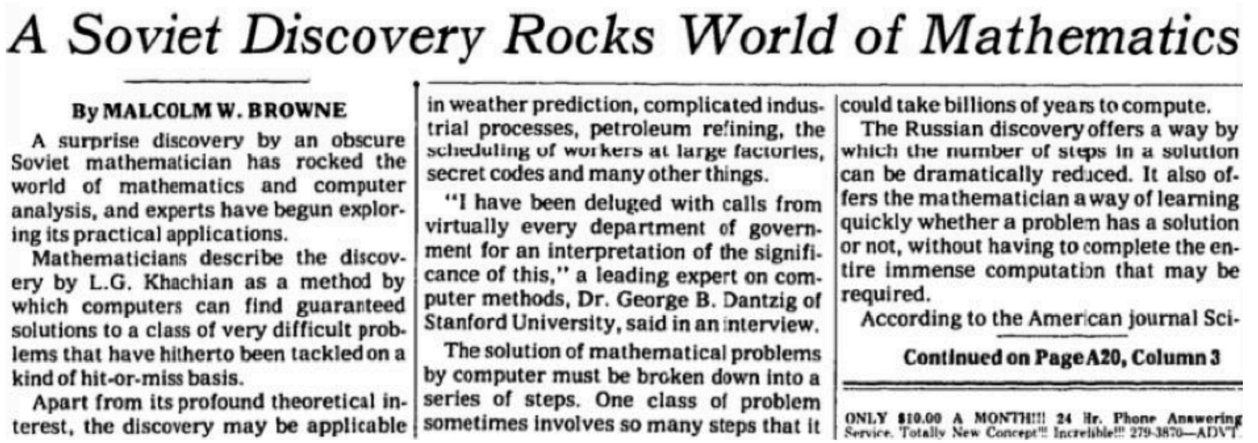
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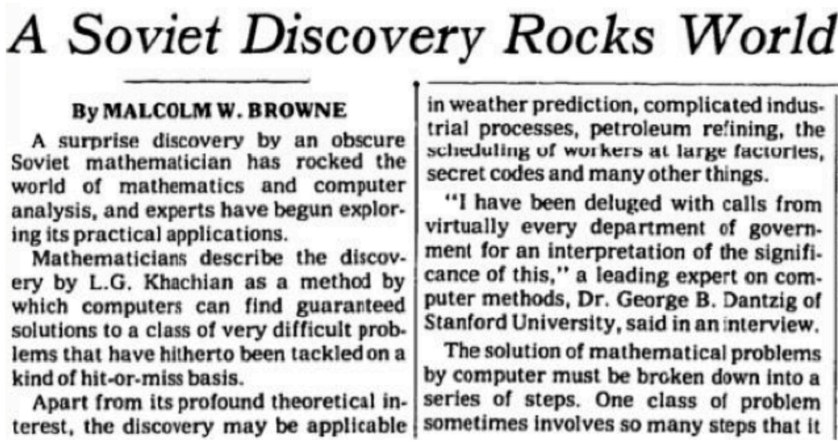
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Then the interior point method comes

Dikin's affine scaling

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & \langle c, x \rangle \\ \text{subject to} \quad & Ax = b \\ & x \geq 0 \end{aligned}$$

Starting from feasible $x > 0$, find d such that $x + d$ remains feasible

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{d} \quad & \langle c, d \rangle \\ \text{subject to} \quad & A(x + d) = b \\ & x + d \geq 0 \end{aligned}$$

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- When $x > 0$, the update ask how far to go with respect to each coordinate

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- When $x > 0$, the update ask how far to go with respect to each coordinate
- $\{d : \|X^{-1} d\| \leq 1\}$ is called Dikin's ellipsoid

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Starting from feasible $x > 0$, find d such that $x + d$ remains feasible

$$\min_{d} \quad \langle c, d \rangle \qquad \text{subject to} \qquad Ad = 0 \qquad \|X^{-1}d\| \leq 1$$

$$d' \leftarrow X^{-1}d$$

$$\min_{d'} \quad \langle Xc, d' \rangle \qquad \text{subject to} \qquad AXd' = 0 \qquad \|d'\| \leq 1$$

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$$d = -\frac{XP_{AX}Xc}{\|P_{AX}Xc\|}$$

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$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad \langle c, x \rangle \qquad \text{subject to} \quad Ax = b, \quad x \geq 0$$

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$$d = -\frac{XP_{AX}Xc}{\|P_{AX}Xc\|} \qquad P_{AX} = I - XA^\top (AX^2A^\top)^{-1}AX$$

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Projected gradient

$$d = -\frac{\overbrace{XP_{AX}Xc}}{\|P_{AX}Xc\|}$$

$$P_{AX} = I - XA^\top (AX^2A^\top)^{-1}AX$$

Dikin's affine scaling

Initialize $x^1 > 0$

$$d_k = -\frac{X^k P_{AX^k} X^k c}{\|P_{AX^k} X^k c\|} \qquad x^{k+1} = x^k + t d_k, \quad t < 1$$

Dikin's affine scaling

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- x^k is feasible all the time

Dikin's affine scaling

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- x^k is feasible all the time
- Good performance on a few LP problems

Dikin's affine scaling

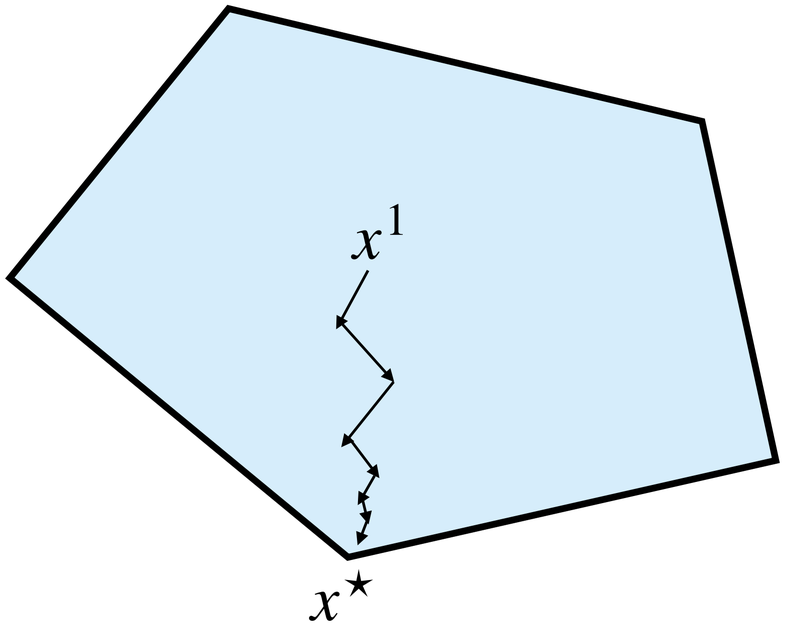
Initialize $x^1 > 0$

$$d_k = -\frac{X^k P_{AX^k} X^k c}{\|P_{AX^k} X^k c\|} \qquad x^{k+1} = x^k + t d_k, \quad t < 1$$

- x^k is feasible all the time
- Good performance on a few LP problems
- Unstable on some problems

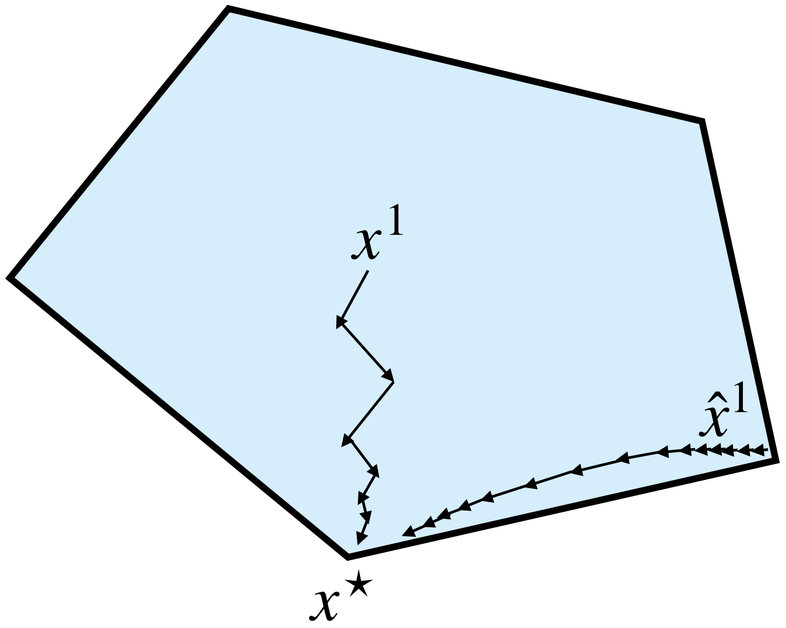
Failure of affine scaling IPM

$$d_k = -\frac{X^k P_{AX^k} X^k c}{\|P_{AX^k} X^k c\|}$$



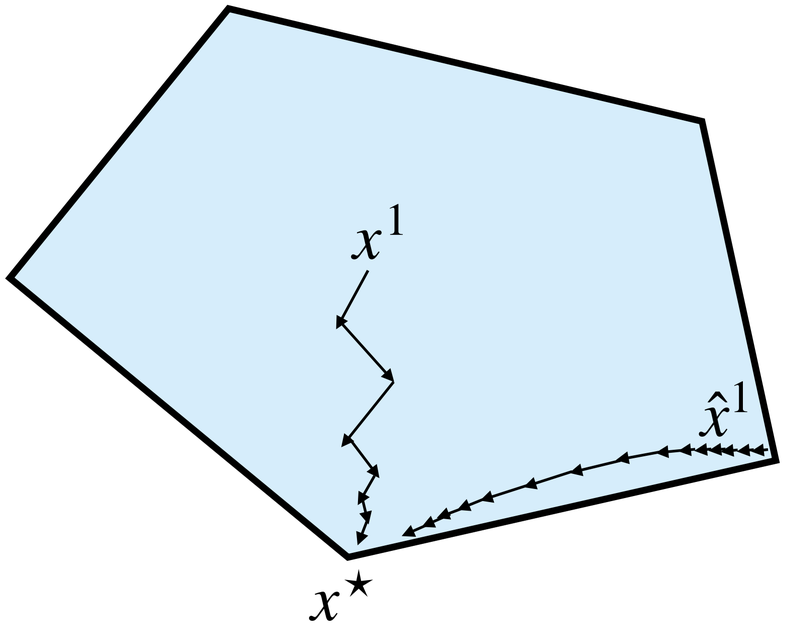
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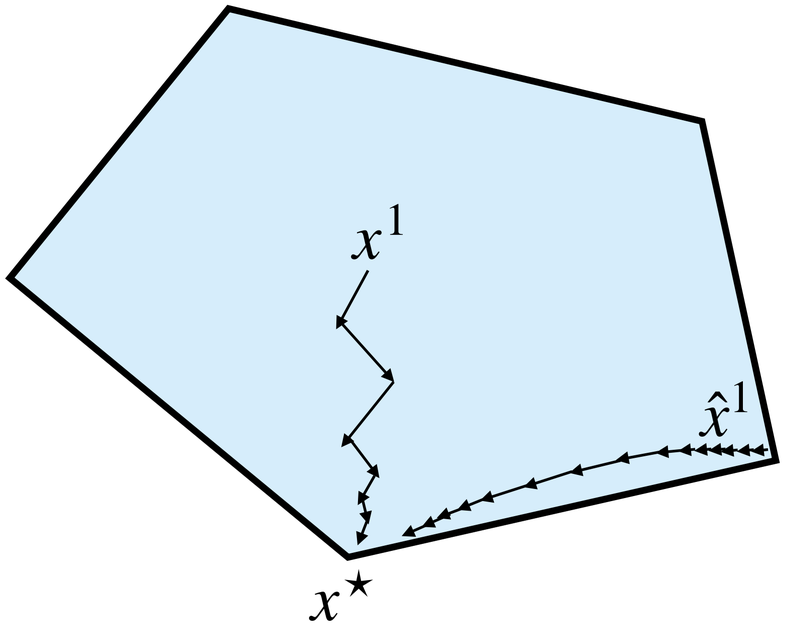
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Size of d_k is proportional to x^k

Failure of affine scaling IPM

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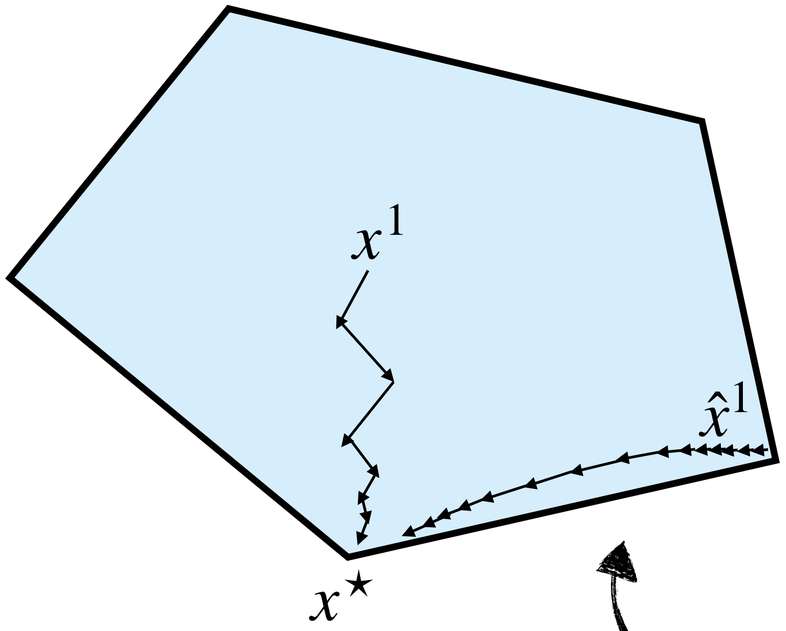


Size of d_k is proportional to x^k

Affine scaling can be trapped by a bad initial point

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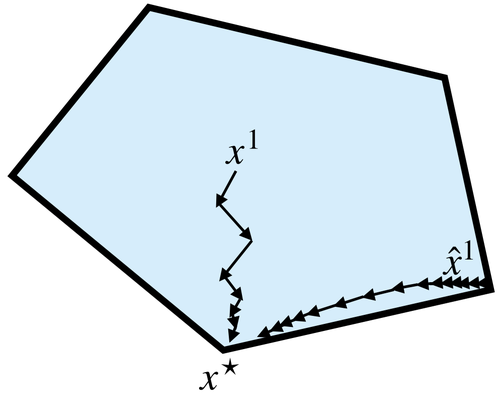


Size of d_k is proportional to x^k

Affine scaling can be trapped by a bad initial point

What makes these two points different?

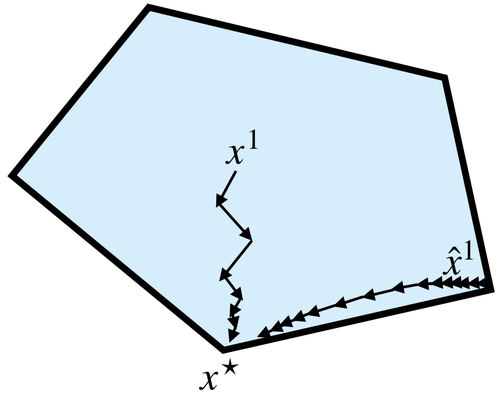
Centrality



Affine scaling works well when the point is at the center

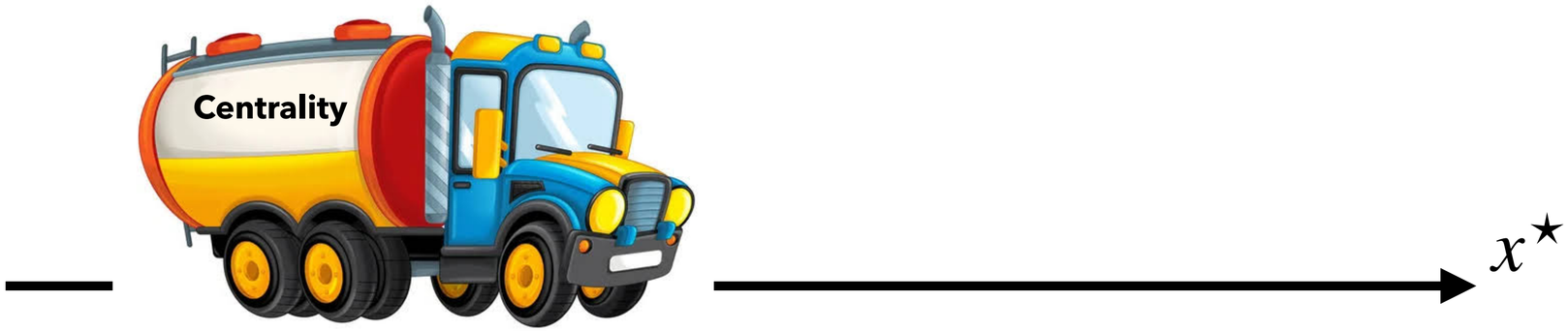
Centrality provides a chance to recover from biased direction

Centrality

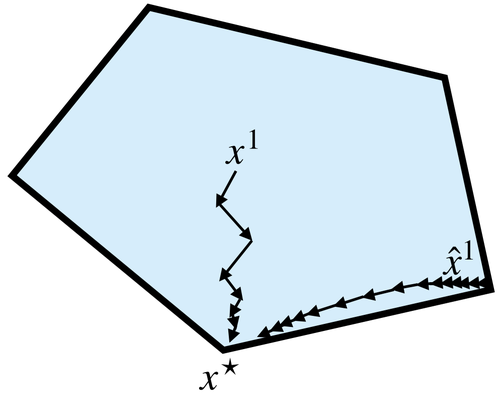


Affine scaling works well when the point is at the center

Centrality provides a chance to recover from biased direction

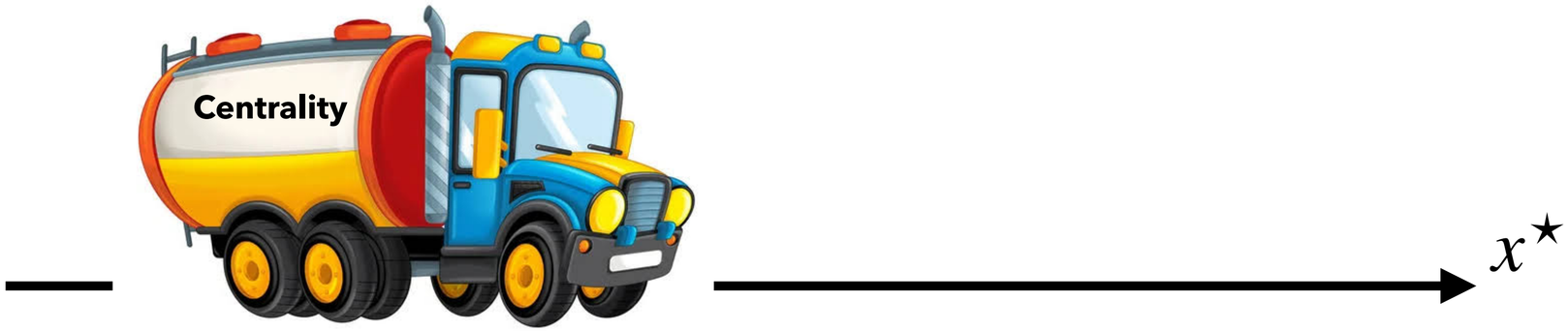


Centrality



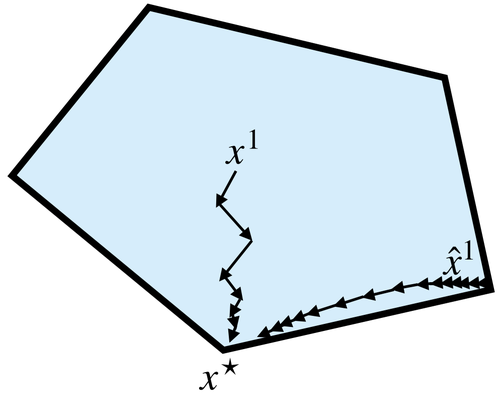
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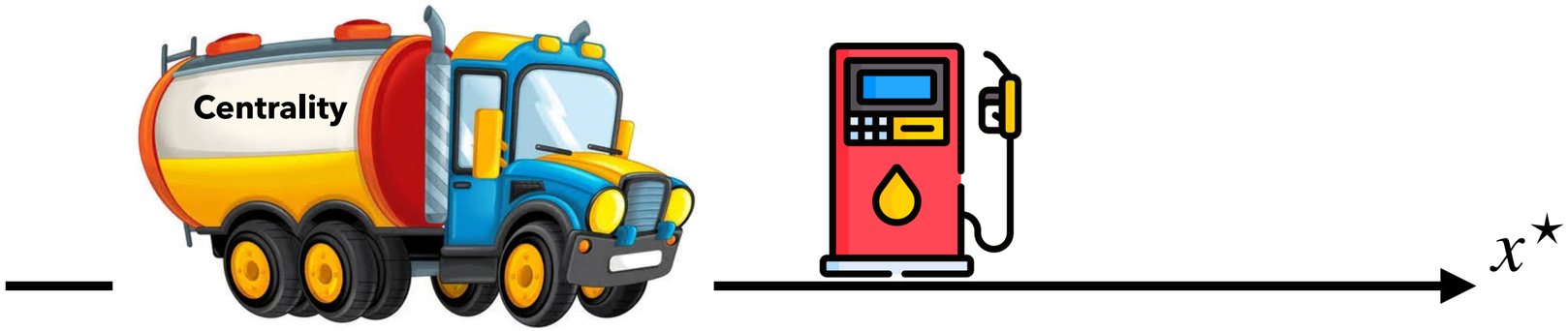
Idea: consume centrality sparingly when approaching optimality

Centrality



Affine scaling works well when the point is at the center

Centrality provides a chance to recover from biased direction



Idea: consume centrality sparingly when approaching optimality

+ restore centrality when it's insufficient

Analytic center

Given a polyhedron $\{x : Ax = b, x \geq 0\}$, its analytic center is the minimizer of

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Balancing optimality and centrality

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At point x, we have

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- The region $\{x : \delta_\mu(x) \leq 1\}$ is called the central path neighborhood at parameter μ

Path-following

$$x^+ = x - XP_{AX}\left(\frac{Xc}{\mu} - \mathbf{1}\right)$$

For $\delta_\mu(x) \leq \frac{1}{2} < 1$

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Convergence of IPM is determined by the reduction in μ

Polynomiality of IPM

Initialize $\mu^1 = 1, \quad \delta_{\mu^1}(x^1) \leq \frac{1}{2}$

$$x^{k+1} = x^k - X^k P_{AX^k}\left(\frac{X^k c}{\mu^k} - \mathbf{1}\right)$$

$$\mu^{k+1} \leftarrow (1-\theta)\mu^k$$

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$$\Rightarrow \mathcal{O}(\sqrt{n}\log(\frac{n}{\varepsilon})) \text{ iterations for } \varepsilon \text{ accuracy}$$

Barrier penalty form

$$\begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & \langle c, x \rangle \\ \text{subject to} \quad & Ax = b \\ & x \geq 0 \end{aligned} \quad \Rightarrow \quad \begin{aligned} \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad & \langle c, x \rangle - \mu \sum_{i=1}^{n} \log x_i \\ \text{subject to} \quad & Ax = b \end{aligned}$$

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Barrier $-\log x$ serves as an approximation of $x \geq 0$

Driving parameter $\mu \to 0$ progressively improves approximation

KKT form and Newton step

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} \quad \langle c, x \rangle - \mu \sum_{i=1}^{n} \log x_i$$

subject to $Ax = b$

$$\max_{y,s} \quad \langle b, y \rangle + \mu \sum_{i=1}^{n} \log s_i$$

subject to $A^\top y + s = c$

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Primal-dual and dual IPM

$$A(x + d_x) = b$$

$$A^\top(y + d_y) + s + d_s = c$$

Primal IPM

$$s - \mu X^{-1}\mathbf{1} = 0$$

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Implementation

The key computation in IPM is solving the linear system

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A(x + d_x) &= 0 \\
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$$
\begin{pmatrix} 0 & A^\top & I \\ A & 0 & 0 \\ \mu X^{-2} & 0 & I \end{pmatrix}
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Augmented system (quasi-definite)

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Normal equation (positive-definite)

$$
AX^2A^\top d_y = w
$$

Practical performance

Iter	Primal.Obj	Dual.Obj	Compl	Primal.Inf	Dual.Inf	Time
0	+1.73051376e+04	+3.14331798e+02	5.99e+04	1.56e+03	1.96e+01	0.49s
1	+5.24131224e+03	-3.25290528e+02	1.10e+04	2.15e+02	3.08e+00	0.50s
2	+9.51739796e+02	+4.84745156e+01	1.03e+03	1.63e+00	1.23e-01	0.50s
3	+5.13471553e+02	+1.45588908e+02	3.67e+02	6.77e-01	1.36e-03	0.50s
4	+4.55820481e+02	+2.40142970e+02	2.14e+02	4.38e-01	7.27e-04	0.50s
5	+3.24215163e+02	+2.77338335e+02	4.65e+01	8.85e-02	1.28e-04	0.50s
6	+2.95732755e+02	+2.80911795e+02	1.47e+01	2.58e-02	2.67e-05	0.50s
7	+2.90139601e+02	+2.81887980e+02	8.19e+00	1.47e-02	9.03e-06	0.50s
8	+2.85000111e+02	+2.82532985e+02	2.45e+00	4.16e-03	2.37e-06	0.50s
9	+2.83156890e+02	+2.82838865e+02	3.17e-01	3.42e-04	6.84e-07	0.50s
10	+2.82978845e+02	+2.82936906e+02	4.19e-02	1.67e-05	1.46e-07	0.50s
11	+2.82960676e+02	+2.82960153e+02	5.23e-04	9.05e-08	2.30e-09	0.50s
12	+2.82960474e+02	+2.82960474e+02	3.56e-08	1.40e-11	2.66e-14	0.50s

IPM is arguably the most efficient algorithm for LPs

- Primal-dual IPM is widely implemented in commercial and open-source solvers
- Also the most efficient for medium-scale conic problems
- ≤ 30 iterations for most problems
- Local superlinear convergence

Summary

- Balance between optimality and centrality
- Homotopy path-following analysis
- Implementation & practical performance